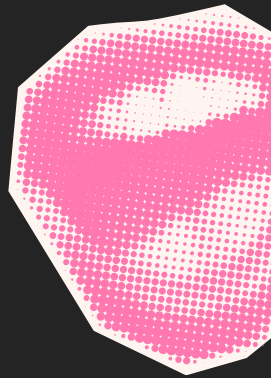
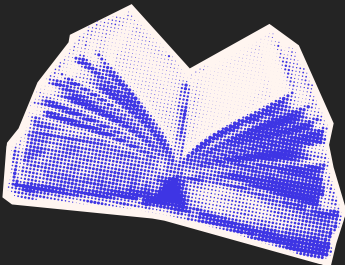


b•ing



how to speak gen z

a guide for brands that want to be a part of the conversation



00 Introduction

| We're the most studied generation in history, and yet, still deeply misunderstood.

Born between 1996 and 2010, we're the first generation to grow up entirely in the post-digital era, with no memory of a world without smartphones or social media (Fromm & Read, 2018; Ngangom, 2020).

We've been shaped by economic crises, cancel culture, online activism, a global pandemic, multiple wars, and a planet that needs our help.

We've seen it all. So now, we expect it all: authenticity, representation, and real action.

| Gen Z doesn't want to be sold to. We want to be understood.

We're sharp, hyper-aware and, above all, attentive. And that shows in how we spend, what we share, and who we choose to support (or ignore).

With global spending power projected to hit \$12 trillion by 2030 (NIQ, 2024), Gen Z isn't the future. We're the now.



This guide isn't a boring manual on digital marketing.

It's an invitation to join a conversation with a generation that no longer accepts recycled formulas, half-measures, or performative activism.

It's about learning how to build real connections, through content designed to unite communities, not just sell to them.

We'll show you how your brand can think, feel, and communicate at Gen Z speed.



01 Brands are not listening

For decades, marketing was a one-way street: brands spoke, and we listened. TV, radio, billboards — one-sided messages, unquestioned.

But that era is over.

Today, the conversation goes **both ways**.

We live in a world where anyone can comment, share, react, create, and be heard.

And when brands don't know how to listen (or don't bother to respond) they lose space, relevance, and respect.

The kind of marketing that works with us is the kind that listens, represents, supports, and shows up.

When we don't feel that?



Scroll



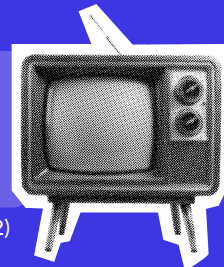
Ghost



Still not convinced? The numbers speak for themselves:

13% of consumers discover new products or brands through traditional TV ads

Source: (PR Newswire, 2022)



85% of Gen Z say that trust is a key factor in their purchase decisions.

Source: (Edelman, 2021)

31% of Gen Z name TikTok as their go-to platform for help making buying decisions.

Source: (IZEA, 2023)



Source: (@ayanahyman on TikTok)

02 What do we want?



Spoiler: it's not TikTok dances.

We want authenticity.

We're done with polished content, empty slogans, and brands that only show up when it's time to sell.

What we're looking for is connection, representation, and to **see our voices amplified**.

We don't follow brands.

We follow causes, people, and ideas we believe in.

Want to know what we truly value?

- ☒ **Transparency:** we want to know who's behind the brand and what they stand for.
- ☒ **Real inclusion:** diversity we can see and feel — not just a checkbox.
- ☒ **Humor + chaos:** memes, irony, and a little mess are part of our language.
- ☒ **Active participation:** we want to co-create, speak up, and be part of it.
- ☒ **Meaningful entertainment:** we learn, laugh, and think — all at once.



69% are willing to pay more when a brand's values align with their own.

Source: (Meio & Mensagem, 2021)

77%

of Gen Z prefer buying from brands they already follow on social media.

Source: (SproutSocial, 2019)



65%

say a company's CEO and employees influence their purchasing decisions.

Source: (Accenture, 2018)

Gen Z loyalty isn't bought. It's earned.

03 How to win us over?

You don't need to change who you are, just how you communicate.
The secret isn't in chasing every trend, it's in understanding what drives them.

There's no magic formula, but here are a few principles to get you started:

1. Listen before you speak

Check your comments. Read the DMs. Watch what your audience is posting and what they're saying about you (and others in your space).
The content is already there, created by the people you're trying to reach.

2. Adapt your tone

Don't try to sound "cool" by using slang you don't understand.
Be real. No filters. No pretending.
Find your voice and speak to your audience like you would to your closest friends.

3. Give before you ask

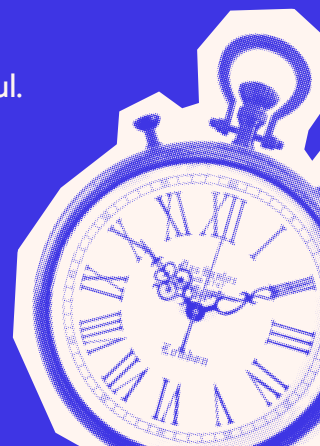
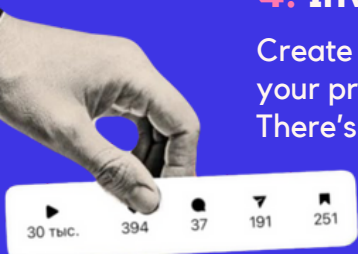
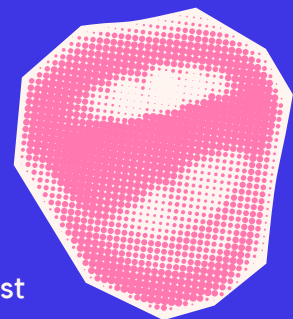
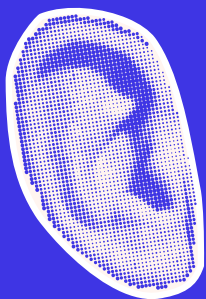
Offer value before you try to sell. Educational, inspiring, or just genuinely helpful content builds trust.
Teach your audience about your product, how it helps, and show them your behind-the-scenes.

4. Involve your community

Create space for co-creation. Pay attention to how your audience is using your product, sometimes in ways you didn't expect.
There's always more than one "right" way to engage.

5. Know when to show up... and when to step back

You don't need to react to everything. Be present, but make it meaningful.
Choose partners and influencers that actually align with your brand.
It's not about the biggest following. It's about the right fit.
Quality > Quantity. Always.



04 Brands who are fluent in Gen z



Sound impossible? If these brands pulled it off, so can you.



1. Nude Project

Born from a DIY attitude and anti-corporate mindset, Nude Project became a cultural phenomenon by treating their audience as co-creators, not consumers.

Their content is raw, real, and unapologetically Gen Z. Every piece feels like it came from a group chat, not a boardroom.

2. Rare Beauty

Founded by Selena Gomez, Rare Beauty broke the mould by turning vulnerability into a branding superpower.

With mental health advocacy, inclusive campaigns and real-skin visuals, they've built more than a brand: they've built a safe space.



3. Cécred Hair

More than a celeb brand. Cécred stands out by educating its community about hair health, cultural identity and self-care.

With BTS content, expert interviews and testimonials, they turn a product line into a learning experience.

4. Poppi

They're the blueprint for how to "do" Gen Z branding: bold colours, creator-first strategy, aesthetic chaos that somehow works.

Their viral success comes from leveraging relatable faces, microinfluencers and community-generated content.





05 Ready to join the conversation?

If you've made it this far, then you already know: **traditional marketing doesn't work for a generation that lives outside the box.**

But this is just the first step.

The next? **Turning knowledge into action.**

Join us. Let's build something real.

If you're ready to rethink your strategy, create content with meaning, and connect with a generation that doesn't tolerate anything fake — Being is your space.



Talk to us.

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 boinghigher.com

 [being.social](https://www.instagram.com/being.social)